



DATA FOR GOOD

June 22, 2026,

Dear FOIA Officer,

RECORDS REQUESTED. I request copies of all National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) records prepared, received, completed, or dated on or after July 1, 2025 that relate to the detention facilities or facility sites identified below.

This includes but is not limited to:

- Records of Environmental Consideration (RECs)
- Categorical exclusion determinations
- Environmental assessments
- Findings of no significant impact
- Environmental impact statements, draft or final
- Notices of intent and notices of availability
- Scoping materials and supporting technical studies
- Correspondence between ICE and any third-party environmental, engineering, or consulting firm concerning NEPA review for these sites

This request covers NEPA review conducted under the Department of Homeland Security's NEPA implementing procedures (DHS Directive 023-01 and Instruction Manual 023-01-001-01) as applied by ICE.

FACILITIES BY ADDRESS

- 1623 East J Street, Tacoma, WA 98421
- 10400, 10450, and 10250 Rancho Road, Adelanto, CA 92301
- 22844 Virginia Boulevard, California City, CA 93505
- 7488 Calzada De La Fuente, San Diego, CA 92154
- 806 Hilbig Road, Conroe, TX 77301
- 830 Pinehill Road, Jena, LA 71342
- 3130 Oakland Street, Aurora, CO 80010
- 100 Highway Terrace, Leavenworth, KS 66048
- 3925 Highway 190 W, Hammond, LA 70401

ALTERNATE FACILITY NAMES. To assist your search, some of the sites above, and related sites, may appear in ICE records under the following facility names:

- Northwest ICE Processing Center, Tacoma, Washington
- California City Detention Center, California City, California
- Otay Mesa Detention Center, San Diego, California
- Mesa Verde ICE Processing Center, California
- Montgomery Processing Center, Conroe, Texas

- Central Louisiana Processing Center, Jena, Louisiana
- Aurora ICE Processing Center, Aurora, Colorado
- Winn Processing Center, Winnfield, Louisiana

FORMAT. Please provide responsive records in electronic format, as native files or searchable PDFs, delivered through the SecureRelease portal.

I request a full waiver of all fees under 5 U.S.C. 552(a)(4)(A)(iii) and 6 C.F.R. 5.11(k). Disclosure of these records is in the public interest because it is likely to contribute significantly to public understanding of the operations and activities of the government, and the records are not sought for any commercial purpose.

The request satisfies each of the six factors DHS applies under 6 C.F.R. 5.11(k)(2) and (k)(3).

1. The subject concerns the operations and activities of the government. The records document ICE's environmental review under NEPA of specific real properties in connection with the agency's detention capacity. NEPA compliance is a federal agency function, and the requested records are agency records that reflect how ICE is carrying it out.
2. The records are meaningfully informative about those operations. Records of environmental consideration, categorical exclusion determinations, environmental assessments, and the supporting correspondence and studies show what ICE evaluated, when, on what basis, and with which contractors and consultants. This information is not otherwise in the public domain. The agency has not published these NEPA determinations for the identified sites, and they cannot be reconstructed from public sources.
3. Disclosure will contribute to the understanding of a broad audience, not merely to my own. Project Salt Box is a news media organization that reports on ICE detention expansion, federal contracting, and immigration enforcement infrastructure for a general readership. We publish reporting and primary-source records at projectsaltbox.com, distribute analysis through a regular newsletter, and maintain a public archive of FOIA requests and released government records so that other journalists, researchers, and members of the public can use them. Our reporting on detention acquisition and federal procurement has been presented to professional audiences, including at the Global Investigative Journalism Network conference. We have both the editorial capacity and the established channels to place these records before a wide audience and to explain their significance.
4. The contribution to public understanding will be significant. ICE's reported plan to acquire turnkey detention facilities from private operators represents a substantial expansion of federal detention capacity. The NEPA records requested here are the primary evidence of which specific sites the government is evaluating for that expansion and how the environmental and community effects are being assessed. Publishing and analyzing these records will materially advance public understanding of decisions that have direct consequences for the affected communities and for federal spending, well beyond what is currently known.
5. I have no commercial interest in the records. Project Salt Box is a noncommercial investigative publication. The records are sought for news reporting and analysis, will be provided to the public at no charge, and will not be sold, licensed, or used to generate direct economic return.

6. The public interest in disclosure outweighs any commercial interest. There is no commercial interest to weigh against the substantial public interest described above. Under 6 C.F.R. 5.11(k)(3)(ii), where a news media requester satisfies the public interest standard, the public interest is presumed to be the interest primarily served by disclosure. That presumption applies here.

For these reasons, the request meets the statutory and regulatory standard, and the fee waiver should be granted in full. If the waiver is denied in whole or in part, please state the specific factor or factors you find unmet so that I may respond, and please notify me before incurring any charges above 25.00 dollars.